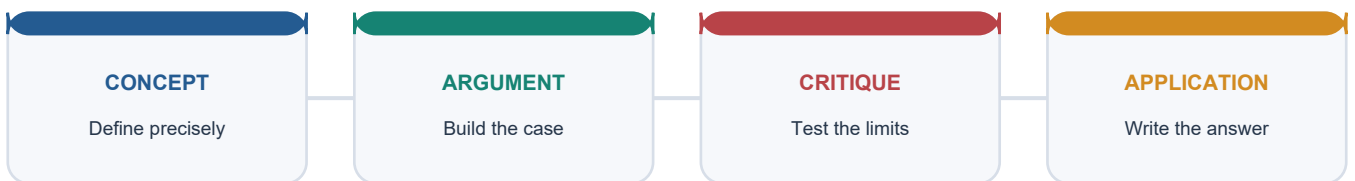


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

The Rig Vedic Age (Early Vedic) - ASCII Master Flow Diagram

ASCII Master Flow Diagram

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

The Rig Vedic Age (Early Vedic) - ASCII Master Flow Diagram

+-----+ PANEL 1/14 - 1. SOURCE AND CHRONOLOGY +-----+ Rig Veda = ten-mandala oral ritual-poetic corpus, not chronicle/census. Books 2-7 = conventional older family-book baseline; Book 10 generally later. Working horizon = c.1500/1200-1000 BCE; no single date for every hymn. Composition -> performance -> oral preservation -> recension -> manuscripts. ANSWER LINE: read every claim through genre, layer and representativeness. +-----+

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	PANEL 2/14 - 2. SAPTA-SINDHU GEOGRAPHY	
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	North-western river world centred on Sindhu/Indus and Punjab tributaries.	
	Vitasta-Jhelum; Asikni-Chenab; Parushni-Ravi; Vipasha-Beas; Shutudri-Sutlej.	
	Kubha-Kabul; Suvastu-Swat; Krumu-Kurram; Gomati-Gomal in this context.	
	Sarasvati/Ghaggar-Hakra and Drishadvati/Chautang remain qualified.	
	Nadi-stuti = poetic geography, not hydrological or territorial survey.	
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+-----+ PANEL 3/14 - 3. KIN-BASED POLITICAL SCALE +-----+ Kula -> grama -> vis -> jana is a heuristic social scale, not bureaucracy. Grama may mean moving/fighting group; vis and jana are people formations. Gotra's later exogamous system cannot be projected fully backward. People and kin organised authority before bounded territory did. TRAP: do not translate every term by its later dictionary meaning. +-----+

PANEL 4/14 - 4. RAJAN AND FUNCTIONARIES	
Rajan = protector + war leader + ritual patron + distributor of wealth. Purohita = priestly adviser; senani = war leader; gramani = group leader. Authority rested on kin support, success, generosity and ritual legitimacy. Bali = offering/tribute, not assessed regular land tax. NO secure bureaucracy, standing army or mature territorial monarchy.	

PANEL 5/14 - 5. ASSEMBLIES AND PARTICIPATION	
Sabha = deliberative/social/ritual/adjudicative possibilities.	
Samiti = broader tribal gathering/support; exact distinction remains debated.	
Vidatha = ritual + military + distributive + social functions by context.	
Female visibility in some contexts != universal equality or representation.	
ASSEMBLIES show collective life; they are not modern democratic parliaments.	

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	PANEL 6/14 - 6. WARFARE AND BOUNDARY TERMS
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	Gavishti links cattle-search/raid with conflict and prestige.
	Book 7: Sudas of Bharatas defeats confederacy near Parushni/Ravi.
	Dasharajna may preserve history but remains patronage-shaped victory poetry.
	Dasa/dasyu = contextual enemy, outsider, subordinate or mythic adversary.
	TRAP: no fixed racial census, ethnic bloc or territorial empire follows.
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| PANEL 7/14 - 7. CATTLE-CENTRED MIXED ECONOMY
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| Gomat = cattle wealth/status; cattle = gift, traction, ritual and booty.
| Pastoral predominance describes relative value, not exclusive nomadism.
| Kshetra, ploughing, yava, harvest, wells and oxen show cultivation.
| Crafts: wood/chariot, leather, weaving, pottery, metal and household work.
| FORMULA: cattle + cultivation + craft + mobility + exchange.
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| PANEL 8/14 - 8. GIFTS, EXCHANGE AND FISCAL LIMIT
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| Dana = chiefly gift; dakshina = sacrificial fee; bali = offering/tribute.
| Nishka = valuable metal object/ornament, not automatically a coin.
| Booty and barter moved cattle, horses, produce and crafted goods.
| Redistribution produced status and priest-chief alliance.
| NO coin-tax bureaucracy or regular territorial fiscal state is demonstrated.
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| PANEL 9/14 - 9. HOUSEHOLD, GENDER AND DIFFERENTIATION
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| Household combined kinship, herding, farming, craft, ritual and alliance.
| Patriline, son preference and unequal authority indicate patriarchy.
| Ghosha, Apala, Lopamudra, Vishvavara = female-seer traditions, layer-cautious.
| Chiefs, priests, warriors, producers, artisans and dependants were unequal.
| Female visibility qualifies patriarchy; it does not establish equality.
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| PANEL 10/14 - 10. VARNA AND PURUSHA LAYER
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| Varna language expresses order/status/boundary and varies by context.
| Rig Veda 10.90: Brahmana + Rajanya + Vaishya + Shudra.
| Book 10 is generally later within the corpus.
| PROVES: emerging/finally articulated fourfold ideology.
| DOES NOT PROVE: rigid hereditary jati/caste across all Early Vedic society.
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| PANEL 11/14 - 11. RELIGIOUS WORLD
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| Indra = battle/storm/rain; Agni = mediation; Varuna = rta/order.
| Soma = drink/deity/inspiration; Ushas = dawn; Ashvins = healing/rescue.
| Rta = cosmic-ritual-moral regularity; yajna = patron-priest-deity reciprocity.
| Henotheism is a bounded modern label for hymnic exaltation, not a creed.
| No monumental temple/idol institution defines the Rigvedic baseline.
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| PANEL 12/14 - 12. MATERIAL, FUNERARY AND ARCHAEOLOGY
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| Ashva/ratha = elite mobility and martial symbolism; not a numerical census.
| Ayas = metal, generally copper/bronze range; not automatic iron.
| Cremation and burial vary; Nasadiya 10.129 questions cosmic origins.
| Late Harappan/Swat/OCF supply contexts; PGW mainly Later Vedic comparison.
| ARCHAEOLOGY identifies assemblages, not language or ethnicity by itself.
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PANEL 13/14 - 13. EARLY TO LATER VEDIC DIRECTION +-----+ Sapta-Sindhu -> Kuru-Panchala/upper Ganga. Cattle-valued mixed economy -> more stable agrarian surplus. Kin chiefship/assemblies -> stronger territorial kingship and hierarchy. Emerging differentiation -> harder varna-patriarchal ideology. Transition was gradual, regional and uneven; continuities persisted. +-----+ v
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+-----+ PANEL 14/14 - 14. PYQ, TRAPS AND ANSWER SPINE +-----+ 2023 GS-I: society + religion + transformed persistence. 2024 GS-I: underline social/economic changes with change verbs. 2026: well evidence, exact river pairs and provisional key discipline. WRITE: source -> date/place -> economy -> polity -> society -> religion. VERDICT: neither pure nomadic equality nor mature caste-tax territorial state. +-----+
